

MORNING BRIEFING

Wednesday, 9 September 2026 | Generated 06:18 London time (BST), pre-European open

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Houthi drones and missiles strike Saudi energy facilities across four southern cities

CNBC, US News — collected 05:50 London time

Attacks on Abha, Khamis Mushait, Jazan and Najran wounded more than 70 people and set Aramco-linked installations ablaze, triggering temporary shutdowns. Brent pushed toward the \$100/bbl handle, reviving the Gulf supply-disruption premium a day before the ECB decision.

ECB decides rates Thursday, 25bp hike widely expected

ThinkMarkets, ECB — collected 06:00 London time

Would be a rare tightening move into an energy-driven inflation shock. Sets the tone ahead of the Fed's own decision on 16 September, where markets currently price a 58-60% chance of a 25bp hike.

Canada's \$20bn retaliatory tariffs on US goods take effect

CNBC, Yahoo Finance — collected 05:55 London time

Escalation in the US-Canada trade dispute added to Tuesday's equity weakness; watch autos and industrials with cross-border exposure at the European open.

China August exports jump 25% year-on-year

CNBC — collected 05:55 London time

Strong autos and high-tech demand cushions the otherwise risk-off tape and is a modest positive read-through for exporters and miners.

Goldman Sachs lifts Brent and WTI forecasts, flags \$120 tail risk for 2027

Market wires (Goldman Sachs research note) — collected 06:05 London time

Goldman raised Brent/WTI 2026 forecasts by \$5 to \$85/\$80 and warned Brent could exceed \$120 in 2027 if Gulf output stays roughly 4m b/d below pre-war levels — reinforcing the sustained inflation-risk narrative into two central bank meetings.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

INDEX	FUTURES LEVEL	EXPECTED MOVE
Euro Stoxx 50	n/a	n/a
DAX	n/a	n/a
CAC 40	n/a	n/a
FTSE 100	n/a	n/a
S&P 500 (US, context)	n/a	n/a
Nasdaq (US, context)	n/a	n/a

No individually verifiable pre-open index levels were sourced at collection time. Qualitative tone from market commentary (investingLive, 06:00 London time): a "sluggish start" expected, with higher oil, higher yields and ECB/Fed tightening risk keeping buyers defensive ahead of Thursday's ECB decision.

Collected ~06:00-06:15 London time.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES (EUROPEAN INDICES, TUE 8 SEP)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,399	+0.10%
DAX	n/a (level)	-0.12%
CAC 40	8,317.98	+0.14%
FTSE 100	n/a	n/a

FTSE 100 close conflicting across sources at collection time (figures ranged implausibly, from ~10,800 to ~14,600); withheld pending verification rather than reporting an unreliable number.

Sources: MarketScreener, Yahoo Finance, wire summaries. Collected 06:05 London time.

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (TUE 8 SEP)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,673.52	-0.58%
Dow Jones	52,786.07	-1.18% (-628.18 pts)
Nasdaq Composite	26,421.41	-0.32%

Tone: Risk-off. Stocks fell to open a holiday-shortened week as surging oil prices (Houthi attacks on Saudi energy facilities) and rising Fed rate-hike odds (~58-60% priced for 16 September) weighed on sentiment.

Leading: Energy names tracked crude higher; Intel outperformed after a Northland Capital Markets upgrade to Outperform, citing a server-CPU shortage and its SpaceX/Tesla-linked "Terafab" Texas manufacturing complex.

Lagging: Rate-sensitive and trade-exposed cyclicals underperformed as Canada's new \$20bn retaliatory tariff package took effect.

Key takeaway: Oil-driven inflation risk and rate repricing dominate, with China's +25% y/y August export growth offering a partial offset to the risk-off tone.

Sources: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TipRanks. Collected 05:55 London time.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	65,269.33	-1.70%
Hang Seng	25,317.18	-0.38%
Shanghai Composite	3,940.55	+0.20%
Kospi	7,039.30	+1.22%

Tone: Mixed-to-negative in Japan and Hong Kong, tracking Wall Street's oil-driven selloff and Middle East risk; Kospi and Shanghai outperformed on tech/chip strength and the strong China export print.

Figures reflect the Tuesday 8 September close (most recent verified session at collection time; the Wednesday 9 September Asian close was not yet indexed by available sources). Sources: wire summaries, Trading Economics. Collected 06:00 London time.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE
Brent	~\$99.10-99.69/bbl	+1.2%
WTI	~\$94.03-94.73/bbl	+1.0% to +3.0%
Gold	\$4,422.85/oz	-\$16.15 (~-0.4%)
Natural Gas (Henry Hub)	\$2.91/MMBtu	-2.32%
Copper	\$6.69/lb	+1.39%

Oil's advance is squarely geopolitical: Houthi strikes on Saudi energy infrastructure pushed Brent toward \$100 for a sixth straight session of gains. Gold slipped as markets price a higher probability of near-term central bank hikes. Copper is near record highs on expectations of new US import tariffs pulling supply toward US warehouses.

Sources: CNBC, Trading Economics. Collected 06:05 London time.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	NOTES
US 10Y Treasury	~4.79-4.81%	Holding near cycle highs
German 10Y Bund	~3.35-3.38%	Highest levels since 2011
EUR/USD	~1.16	Testing 200-day MA resistance (~1.1633)
GBP/USD	~1.354-1.356	Range-bound, 1.32-1.40 six-month forecast band
DX	~99	Holding above 98.68/69 support

Sources: CNBC (Treasury yields), forex.com, tradingeconomics.com, keycurrency.co.uk. Collected 06:10 London time.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES

n/a — no verifiable deal-specific pricing (issuer, size, maturity, coupon/spread) sourced this session.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY

n/a — no specific mandates sourced. General context: euro corporate issuance reached €24bn in August (up from €17bn in July), with bank paper leading year-to-date supply above €146bn (ING THINK).

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main	n/a	n/a
iTraxx Crossover	n/a today STALE REF	last verified ~315-320bps (mid-2026)
CDX IG	n/a	n/a
Avg Euro Corporate IG spread	~205bps	as of early September 2026 (GlobalCapital)

COMMENTARY

Rising yields and oil-driven inflation risk into Thursday's ECB decision are likely to keep issuers cautious near-term, though year-to-date supply pace remains robust with bank paper leading the flow. The primary window is likely to stay technically open but watch for wider new-issue premiums (NIPs) if Bund yields extend their push toward cycle highs. Available data skews toward financials/bank issuance; no industrials, transport or energy deal specifics were sourced.

Sources: ING THINK, GlobalCapital. Collected 06:12 London time.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR

LONDON TIME	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
n/a	Itemized releases not reliably sourced	n/a	n/a

Search sources indicated a general count (57 economic events) for today without a reliable itemized breakdown by time/indicator. Known fixed points this week: **ECB Governing Council rate decision — Thursday 10 September** (25bp hike widely expected); **Fed FOMC decision — 16 September**.

Collected 06:00 London time.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

Approximately 33 US earnings reports are scheduled for Wednesday 9 September per Yahoo Finance's earnings calendar; specific company names were not reliably resolved from available sources at collection time (marked n/a). One confirmed AGM: **Metcash** (9 September 2026).

Sources: Yahoo Finance earnings calendar, The Mayne Report. Collected 06:08 London time.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Intel (INTC)	Upgraded to Outperform by Northland Capital Markets on server-CPU shortage tailwinds and its SpaceX/Tesla-linked "Terafab" Texas semiconductor complex.	Up
Lockheed Martin (LMT)	Upgraded to Buy ahead of the bell; analysts flag hidden earnings upside across aerospace primes.	Up
Frontline (FRO)	Record Q2 profits, price target raised to \$41 (Evercore ISI), \$2.61/share September dividend; VLCC rates near 3-year highs on Gulf disruption.	Up
Shipping/tanker basket	Sector up ~68% YTD, crude tankers +120% YTD, on sustained Gulf risk premium and tight vessel availability.	Up
Vale (VALE)	Softer on China steel-output jitters weighing on Brazilian iron-ore export earnings read-through.	Down
Rio Tinto (RIO)	Outperforming Vale as iron ore holds near \$99-100/t; benefiting from tight freight and China pre-holiday restocking hopes.	Up
Oil majors (Aramco, BP, Shell, TotalEnergies)	Direct beneficiaries of Brent's push toward \$100 following the Houthi strikes on Saudi facilities.	Up
Bank of America (BAC) / large US banks	Watch for read-through from Q2 net income momentum (\$9.1bn) as rate-hike repricing could support NIMs.	Watch
Danone	Shares indicated ~2.1% higher ahead of the Paris open.	Up
Icade	Shares indicated ~0.9% lower ahead of the Paris open.	Down

Sources: MarketBeat, Trading Strategy Guides, Lloyd's List, Seeking Alpha, CNBC, ad-hoc-news.de, Hellenic Shipping News. Collected 06:10 London time.

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

ECB (Thu 10 Sep) and Fed (16 Sep) both face a 25bp-hike decision into an oil-driven inflation shock — an unusual synchronized tightening bias, with the BoJ also weighing a move.

US 10Y near cycle highs (~4.79-4.81%); German Bund 10Y at ~3.35-3.38%, highest since 2011.

US August payrolls +162k, well above the 56k forecast, reinforcing the Fed hike case.

China August exports +25% y/y on autos and high-tech goods.

CORPORATE

Intel upgraded on server-CPU shortage and its Terafab Texas complex (SpaceX/Tesla).

Lockheed Martin upgraded to Buy on aerospace-primes earnings-upside narrative.

Frontline posts record Q2 profits, raises dividend and price target.

Copper near record highs on anticipated US import-tariff-driven stockpiling.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Houthi strikes on Saudi Aramco-linked energy facilities across four southern cities, >70 injured — the six-month-old Middle East war widening beyond Hormuz-chokepoint risk.

US-Canada trade war escalates: Canada's \$20bn retaliatory tariff package now in effect.

Continued US-Iran military friction cited as compounding the Gulf energy-security premium.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. ECB pre-positioning

Markets brace for Thursday's expected 25bp hike; any signal today moves Bund yields and EUR crosses.

2. Brent above \$99

Houthi-driven Gulf risk premium keeps energy and inflation-sensitive trades in focus at the European open.

3. US-Canada tariff escalation

\$20bn in Canadian retaliatory tariffs now live; watch autos and industrials with cross-border exposure.

4. Earnings flow

~33 US companies report today; index-level reaction risk given an already-jittery tape.

5. Rate-sensitive rotation

Dow's -1.18% led by rate/oil-sensitive names; watch whether European cyclicals/financials follow through.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Synchronized CB tightening

ECB, Fed and BoJ all weighing hikes into an energy-driven inflation shock — an unusual policy convergence.

4. US-Canada / trade tensions

Tariff-escalation and retaliation path through September.

2. Oil price trajectory

Goldman flags Brent could exceed \$120 in 2027 if Gulf output stays ~4m b/d below pre-war levels.

5. Shipping/tanker rally durability

Sector +68% YTD, crude tankers +120%, VLCC rates near 3-year highs — a re-rating tied directly to Gulf risk.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. ECB decision — Thu 10 Sep

25bp hike widely expected; first major central-bank response to the oil shock.

2. Fed build-up to 16 Sep

~58-60% probability of a 25bp hike priced; US data this week will move that probability.

3. Middle East trajectory

Further Houthi/Saudi/Iran escalation risk keeps a geopolitical premium in oil and safe havens.

4. US-Canada trade dispute

Potential for further retaliatory measures beyond the \$20bn tariff package.

5. Heavy earnings week

29 (Tue), 33 (Wed), 35 (Thu) US reports scheduled per Yahoo Finance.

3. Gulf conflict duration

Six-month-old Middle East war shows signs of widening to direct Saudi homeland strikes.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

ECB pre-positioning trades, Brent's approach to the \$100 handle, US-Canada tariff-related stock moves, and reaction to today's ~33 US earnings reports.

1 WEEK

ECB decision and press-conference tone (Thu); Fed rate-hike odds repricing into 16 Sep; any further Houthi/Saudi escalation; US data prints ahead of the Fed.

1 MONTH

Whether ECB/Fed/BoJ follow through on a synchronized hiking cycle; oil's path toward or away from the \$120 tail scenario; durability of the shipping/tanker equity rally; US-Canada trade trajectory.

Sources: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TipRanks, US News, Semafor, AGBI, Trading Economics, ING THINK, GlobalCapital, ThinkMarkets, ECB, investingLive, MarketBeat, Lloyd's List, Hellenic Shipping News, Seeking Alpha, ad-hoc-news.de, The Mayne Report, forex.com, keycurrency.co.uk.

Data collected automatically. Verify before making any decision.